

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to plan a press release.



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Can Do Statements

- I can write a press release.
- I can talk about crimes and offenses.
- I can present background information.

Ask your partner:

- How concerned are you about public image?
- How concerned is your workplace about its public image?





Let's Explore!

Farmani talks to the press. Something's **hit close to home***. What is it?

* If something *"hits close to home"* then it affects you in a personal way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

Holly's Wear and Polygon Ready to Confront Human Rights Issues in Tindasia
Deeply disturbed by rumors that Toronto's Holly's Wear production plant in Shalopolis, Tindasia uses child labor, William Farmani (CEO) and Janet Ellis (president of Polygon) are joining forces to overturn human rights abuses and bring community change. Holly's Wear is not the only factory using child labor on the island. Impoverished family members of all ages look to foreign and local companies to employ them and bring rice to their tables. In fact, reputable factories that meet worker safety codes, like Holly's, are workplaces of choice for many.

However, Farmani says, "although legal in Tindasia, this is not acceptable business practice. We must bring positive changes to society rather than finding ourselves complicit in exploitation. These children should be preparing for their futures in school."

"Shocking! It is an outrage! Believe me, I had no idea!"

This was Farmani's reaction when Polygon confronted him with the news they had just learned about the company's human rights concerns. After discovering a rumor through social media, they did a private investigation. Although no crime was found, the company was very upset. The family of one member of management at Polygon has been involved in community relief to the area for several generations. Together, Polygon and Holly's Wear are planning ways to bring better job security to adults that will benefit entire families and keep children in school.





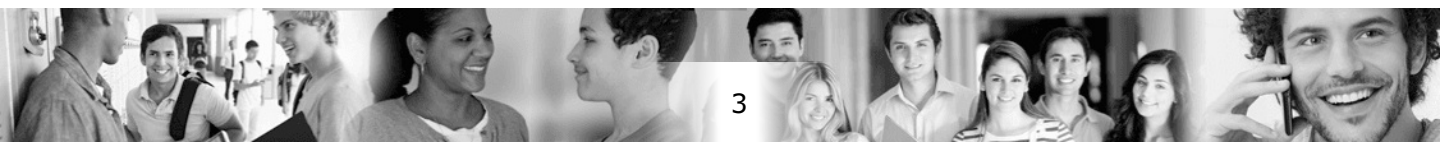
Let's Practice!

Mastering* the structure of a press release.

* To "master" something is to become very good at it.

Instructions: Select the best answer to master the structure of a press release. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. A good example of an attention-grabbing headline:
 - a. Holly's Wear and Polygon Ready to Confront Human Rights Issues in Tindasia!
 - b. Some people in suits to give press conference later today!
 - c. Please join us for a short talk later this afternoon.
2. A good example of an engaging quote:
 - a. "I didn't really know what was going on."
 - b. "Shocking! It is an outrage! Believe me, I had no idea!"
 - c. "I ... uhhh ... wasn't really aware of ... anything."
3. A good example of basic, necessary information:
 - a. We're not sure what the people involved do for a living, but public opinion is not high.
 - b. Giorgio Farmani (CEO) and Janet Ellis (president of Polygon) are joining forces to overturn human rights abuses.
 - c. Giorgio Farmani is known to drive a blue BMW to work.
4. A good example of background information:
 - a. This was Farmani's reaction when Polygon (Holly's Wear's promotion agency) confronted him with the news they had just learned ...
 - b. Tomorrow the company will release a second press release which absolves them of all wrongdoing.
 - c. We hope that they will learn from their mistakes and improve their practices in the future.





Let's Practice!

Let's get some background information on this issue.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Giorgio Farmani and Janet Ellis are joining
2. In fact, reputable
3. Although legal
4. Although no crime
5. We must bring positive changes to society rather than finding ourselves complicit

COLUMN B

- a. in exploitation.
- b. in Tindasia, this is not acceptable business practice.
- c. factories that meet worker safety codes are workplaces of choice for many.
- d. forces to overturn human rights abuses and bring community change.
- e. was found, the company was very upset.





Extension Activity

Write up a press release for the public.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a bad situation that may have affected a business's reputation.
- Write a short paragraph using the *Present* and *Present Continuous Tenses* to state what is happening.
- Make up a key quote, using emotional language, to give readers a particular impression.
- Write another short paragraph, using the *Simple Past Tense*, to give readers a bit of necessary background information.
- Finish with a sentence that explains how your business is going to improve, using the *Present Continuous Tense*.
- Read your press release to a partner.



Target Words

- joined forces** (expression): putting together the energies of various people or groups
e.g. Giorgio Farmani (CEO) and Janet Ellis (president of Polygon) are joining forces.
- to overturn** (verb): to completely change or cancel a decision or situation
e.g. Giorgio Farmani and Janet Ellis are joining forces to overturn human rights abuses and bring community change.
- legal** (adjective): allowed by law
e.g. Although legal in Tindasia, this is not acceptable business practice.
- reputable** (adjective): well-respected
e.g. In fact, reputable factories that meet worker safety codes, like Holly's, are workplaces of choice for many.
- exploitation** (noun): treating someone badly for your own benefit
e.g. We must bring positive changes to society rather than exploitation.
- reaction** (noun): response
e.g. This was Farmani's reaction when Polygon confronted him with the news they had just learned about the company's human rights concerns.
- human rights abuse** (expression): when people are not allowed the most basic things all people should have
e.g. Giorgio Farmani and Janet Ellis will overturn human rights abuses and bring community change.
- crime** (noun): an action that is punishable by law
e.g. Although no crime was found, the company was very upset.
- complicit** (adjective): involved with others in doing wrong
e.g. We must bring positive changes to society rather than finding ourselves complicit in exploitation.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a press release to give a particular impression to the public.

☐ ☐

I use Present Tense to describe a current situation.

☐ ☐

I use Past Tense to give background information.

☐ ☐

I use the Present Continuous Tense to close with what my business is doing now to make things better.

☐ ☐

I share my press release with a partner.

☐ ☐



Learning Points

The Present Simple, Simple Past Tenses and Present Continuous Tense

Simple, direct language is used when writing a short report, so simple tenses are mostly used. The situation is described using the Present Simple Tense, and background to the situation is described using the Simple Past Tense. A few critical sentences using the Present Continuous Tense may describe what is currently in process or what main characters are doing about the situation.

The opening sentence in a report about a current situation may use the Present Simple Tense to describe a situation happening at a general or indefinite time period:

Example: A tornado hits Oklahoma again!

City council members approve the subway plan!

OR

The opening sentence may also use the Present Continuous to make the situation feel more real in the moment:

Example: A Tornado is hitting our city!

City council members are approving the subway plan!

General information is given in the Present Simple tense:

Example: Tornadoes are common in this part of the country but they rarely hit the city. This one is bigger than usual and the city is in its direct path.

Example: City residents urgently want a new subway system. Traffic is much too congested in our city. However, the plan is expensive.

Key background information is used with sentences in the Simple Past to fill in context for readers:

Example: Last year we had several tornado warnings but not one impacted the city. The city developed a new plan for emergency evacuation. Children even practiced tornado drills in school.

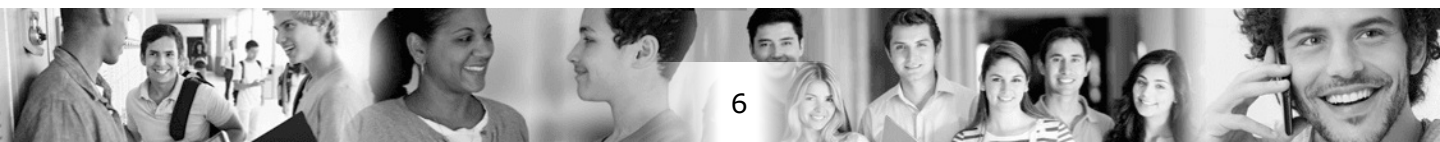
Example: In August, city council was dead-set against beginning the new subway plans. Members claimed it was too expensive for the city budget.

A closing line may end the piece in the *Present Continuous* to inform the reader of the current situation or what key actors are doing about it.

Example: Emergency crews are presently preparing in case there is a need for evacuation.

Example: City council is now planning when the excavation can begin.

(Look for the '-ing' to identify the continuous tense!)





Learning Points

Writing a Press Release

A press release is always given in order to leave the public with a general impression that is important to whoever is being represented. Wording must be carefully chosen to convey this feeling.

Often a press release is written to address a situation that people feel strongly about. Emotional language is used to bring the public into the same mood as the writer. Sometimes the situation has a moral or ethical side to it. Word choice will reflect this.

Words that establish a negative mood situation/feeling	Words that establish a positive mood situation/feeling
Shocking/shocked	Inspiring/inspired
Outrageous/outraged	Amazing/amazed
Horrific/horrified	Wonderful/delighted
Disturbing/disturbed	Encouraging/encouraged

Words that reflect Bad Ethics	Words that reflect Good Ethics
Complicit/guilty	Honest/innocent
Scandalous	Respectable
Disreputable	Reputable
Not acceptable	Acceptable
Irresponsible	Responsible

Examples:

- The CEO of Flying Carpets was outraged (feeling) by the scandalous behaviour of past employee, Frederick Barker (situation).
- The company has a reputable history (situation) and does not find his practices to be acceptable (feeling).
- The company does not want to be complicit in crime (situation) and will be sure to act responsibly (acting because of a particular belief or feeling) about this event.
- An inspiring message was given to the entire staff (situation), encouraging (verb of feeling) everyone of the innocence of their leadership (situation).

